

Content warning: this task contains unobfuscated examples of hate speech that some readers may find offensive.

Annotation Guidelines for Check-worthiness detection on Hate Speech messages

1. Task Description

Your task is to annotate claims of text messages (which are labeled as either hate speech or non-hate speech) from the WSF-ARG+ dataset. In this dataset, a text message is composed of one or several claims which for some text messages constitute an argument.

An **argument** is a part of a discourse that includes:

- **Conclusion:** the main claim being put forward.
- **Premise(s):** evidence that supports or attacks the conclusion.

In short, an argument is more than just an insult or an opinion. It must present a **reasoning process**, even if simple.

Example:

*People who had been vaccinated against COVID also fell ill. Some even died.
Thus, vaccines are ineffective.*

- Claim 1 / Premise 1: *People who had been vaccinated against COVID also fell ill.*
- Claim 2 / Premise 2: *Some even died.*
- Claim 3 / Conclusion: *Vaccines are ineffective.*

The entire message is called an argument composed of two premises supporting one conclusion.

If the text message is not an argument, it will be a composition of **one or several claims**.

Example:

More broadly , of course I wish to see white countries get-on with each other. If it came down to a choice between my country 's interests and those of another white country I would put my own first.

- Claim 1: *More broadly , of course I wish to see white countries get-on with each other.*
- Claim 2: *If it came down to a choice between my country 's interests and those of another white country I would put my own first.*

For each text message you are provided with:

- The full original message.
- The already extracted claims a message has.

- A label if the message is an argument or not.
- And the text message composed by the concatenation of all the claims.

Your task is to annotate, for each text message, each of the claims that compose it according to the check-worthy detection task.

2. Check-worthy detection task

Each claim has to be labeled with one of the following labels:

Non-Factual Statement (NFS)

Subjective or opinion-based statement. Includes opinions, beliefs, personal declarations, wishes, or rhetorical questions. These do **not** contain factual claims/evidence.

Example: *We should go to the southwest and go on the offensive and drive every race down into Mexico.*

Non-Factual (a call to action, not a factual claim/evidence).

Unimportant Factual Statement (UFS)

Contains a factual claim/evidence, but **not important enough** for fact-checking. These are statements of low relevance or interest to the general public.

Example: *When I was last in South Africa, we went to Sun City and saw little black monkey children swimming.*

Unimportant Factual (statement about a past trip and saw a black person, but not worth fact-checking).

Check-worthy Factual Statement (CFS)

Contains a factual claim/evidence that **is important for the general public and should be fact-checked**.

This includes:

- Verifiable claims/evidence.
- Viral or widely shared false information.
- Hoaxes without evidence.
- Probably false claims that are **timely, trending, and consequential** in their context.

Example: *"92% of abortion clinics are in black communities."*

Check-worthy Factual (verifiable, with social and political impact).

3. Other Examples

Premises

- (CFS - HS) If the holocaust was the truth, there would be no laws against saying it was a lie.

- (CFS - Non-HS) Africa is an area rich in natural resources.
- (UFS - HS) I'm going to college with blacks.
- (UFS - Non-HS) Saw a young girl begging on Grafton Street.
- (NFS - HS) It would be cool if someone secretly detonated a nuclear bomb in Kashmir.
- (NFS - Non-HS) If he is a coke addict, you should try to find out where he gets the coke from and rat him out.

Conclusions

- (CFS - HS) I was horrified by the amount of non-white people after moving to Holland.
(hyperbole + assumes demographics)
- (CFS - Non-HS) Crime pays in Ireland.
- (UFS - HS) Birds are able to make better huts than the people of Africa.
- (UFS - Non-HS) We moved out of our neighborhood.
- (NFS - HS) Black people are scum.
Jews should be assumed guilty until proven innocent.
- (NFS - Non-HS) I do not want to teach in a neighborhood like that.
There is a problem with the white race.